

No matter which editor you use, you can try running `import pyperclip` or `import bext` to check if the installation worked. If these import instructions don't produce an error message, these modules installed correctly and you'll be able to run the projects in this book that use these modules.

Copying the Code from This Book

Programming is a skill that you improve by programming. Don't just read the code in this book or copy and paste it to your computer. Take the time to enter the code into the editor for yourself. Open a new file in your code editor and enter the code. Pay attention to the line numbers in this book and your editor to make sure you aren't accidentally skipping any lines. **If you encounter errors, use the online diff tool at <https://inventwithpython.com/bigbookpython/diff/> to show you any differences between your code and the code in this book.** To get a better understanding of these programs, try running them under the debugger.

After entering the source code and running it a few times, try making experimental changes to the code. The comments marked with (!) have suggestions for small changes you can make, and each project lists suggestions for larger modifications.

Next, try re-creating the program from scratch without looking at the source code in this book. It doesn't have to be exactly the same as this program; you can invent your own version!

Once you've worked through the programs in this book, you might want to start creating your own. Most modern video games and software applications are complicated, requiring teams of programmers, artists, and designers to create. However, many board, card, and paper-and-pencil games are often simple enough to re-create as a program. Many of these fall under the category of "abstract strategy games." You can find a list of them at https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_abstract_strategy_games.

Running Programs from the Terminal

The programming projects in this book that use the `bext` module have colorful text for their output. However, these colors won't appear when you run them from Mu, IDLE, or other editors. These programs should be run from a *terminal*, also called *command line*, window. On Windows, run the Command Prompt program from the Start menu. On macOS, run Terminal from Spotlight. On Ubuntu Linux, run Terminal from Ubuntu Dash or press CTRL-ALT-T.

When the terminal window appears, you should change the current directory to the folder with your `.py` files with the `cd` (change directory) command. (*Directory* is another term for folder.) For example, if I were on Windows and saved my Python programs to the `C:\Users\Al` folder, I would enter the following line.